

Figure 1: Home screen

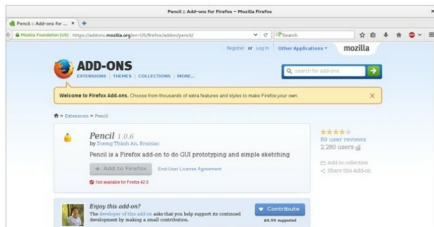


Figure 2: Firefox Add-on page

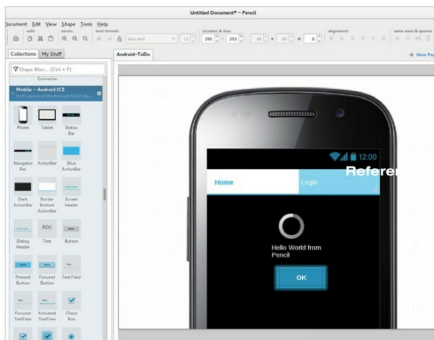


Figure 3: Android app prototyping

widgets. The user can fine tune application prototypes using various options such as *Group*, *Ungroup*, *Style*, *Arrangement* and many more provided in the right-click context menu of the canvas.

Pencil as a Firefox add-on

You can use Pencil as a Firefox add-on via the Mozilla add-on page.

Designing Android applications using Pencil

Pencil provides stencils and templating options for including custom widgets, which are required for designing specific applications such as Android or iOS apps. A list of all available stencils and templates can be found at <http://pencil.evolus.vn/Stencils-Templates.html>.

In order to prototype an Android application using Pencil, download Android Stencils from http://evoluspencil.googlecode.com/files/Android.GUI_v2.zip.

Download the above Zip collection and import this collection using *Tools > Install new collection > Select location of download*.

This will import all widgets available in the collection, which can be accessed in the *Collections* toolbar.

You can also design and prototype iOS applications and Web applications using Pencil stencils and templates, as well as design your own widgets and package them as a collection.

Pencil can export designs in various formats such as SVG, PNG, PDF and even the ODT file format. It is an effective tool, which can save you money as it is free and open source. Also, developers become less dependent on designers. For more information on Pencil, you can visit <http://pencil.evolus.vn/>.

By: Abhijeet Kasurde

The author is a FOSS evangelist and works for Red Hat. He loves to explore new technologies and software. You can contact him at abhijeetkasurde21@gmail.com.